

4 Mobile Platforms

- Streaming
- Access point

4.2 Symbian series 60

Moving on Series 60, we shall now concentrate on the differences between the two first, and then we shall continue to give the details of the latest edition of Series 60 which is touch enabled. The usability of all the basic and essential features such as contact list, themes, date and time and the like is pretty much the same between the two platforms. Instead we will highlight unique points of the Series60 platform.

Given that it was designed for relatively bigger screen devices in general as compared to the series 40 (S40 is limited to a maximum of 320x240), the look and feel of series 60 is clearly more intuitive and pleasing to eyes. Rendering of icons is far better in terms of colour and shape. Support for screens as high as 800 pixels in one dimension goes a long way in making a pleasing user interface.

A major difference in the look and feel is the ability of series 60 to further add folders in the main menu. The main menu is scrollable unsuch as the Series40, where you could rearrange the icons within the menu but couldn't add. The screenshot below would illustrate the difference, the MusicApps folder wasn't there by default and the thumb friendly scrollbar is clearly visible in the right hand side.

The initial minor difference in the look and feel can be deceptive when it comes to functional and technical difference between the two phones.

4.2.1 MultiTasking

Series 40 was aimed at simpler devices aiming to be a function phone, while series 60 is aimed towards convergent devices aiming to be a mini-laptop. Series 40 had no native multitasking support, though it could support Java applications. However, Java applications have the limitation of a maximum size of 1 MB. (heap size cannot exceed 2 MB). Java applications also lack the ability to work in the background.

Enter Series 60 and in such as true OS style has complete multi-tasking support. Pressing the menu key for extended duration on most devices, bring up the taskbar from where you can switch between the applications and also close them if you wish.

In the screenshot below you can clearly see the Browser, Real Player, Fringe (IM application), ScreenSnap (The utility which is generating the screenshots for this



Music Apps folder is visible in the main menu.